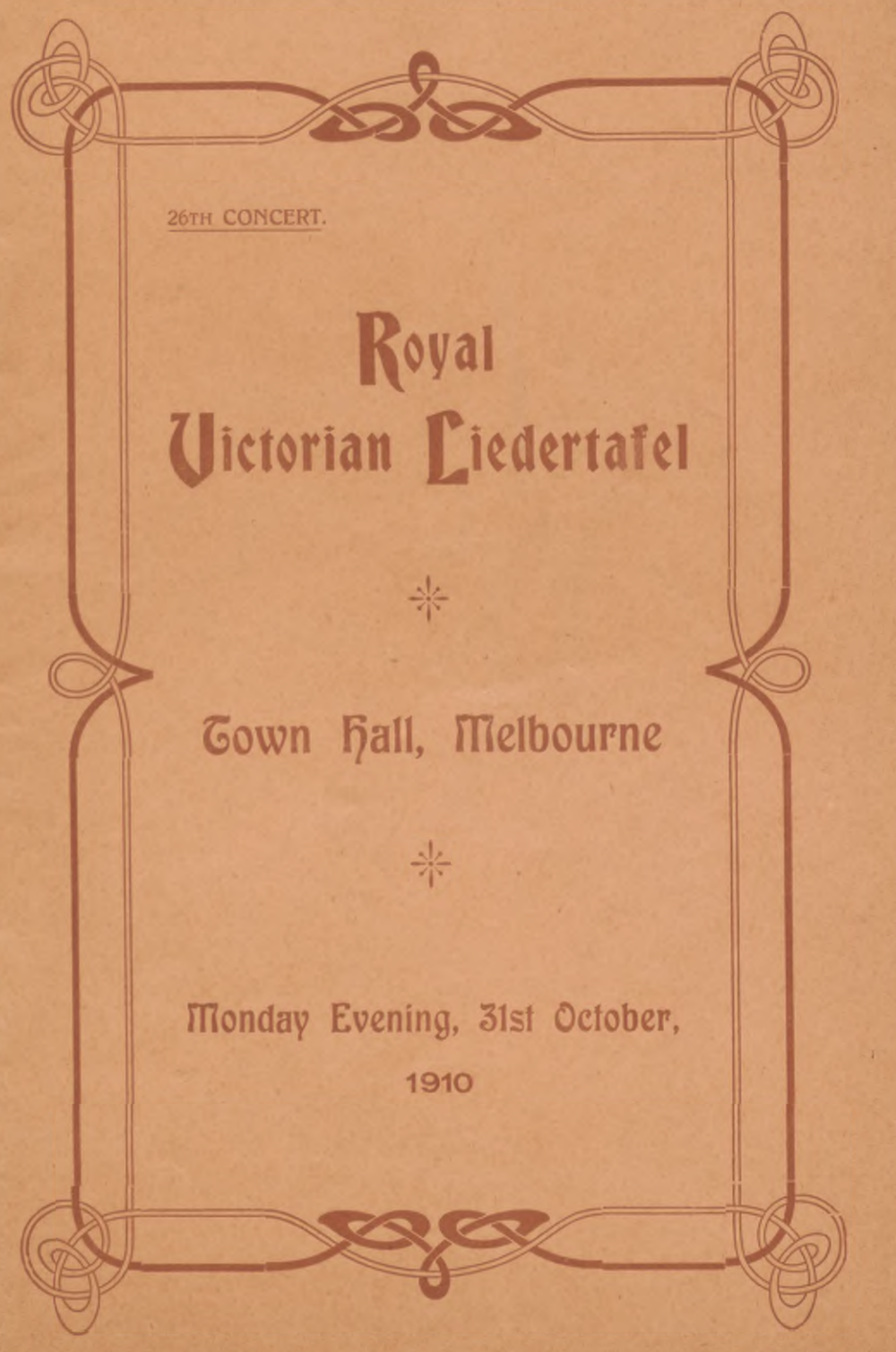




26TH CONCERT.

Royal
Victorian Liedertafel

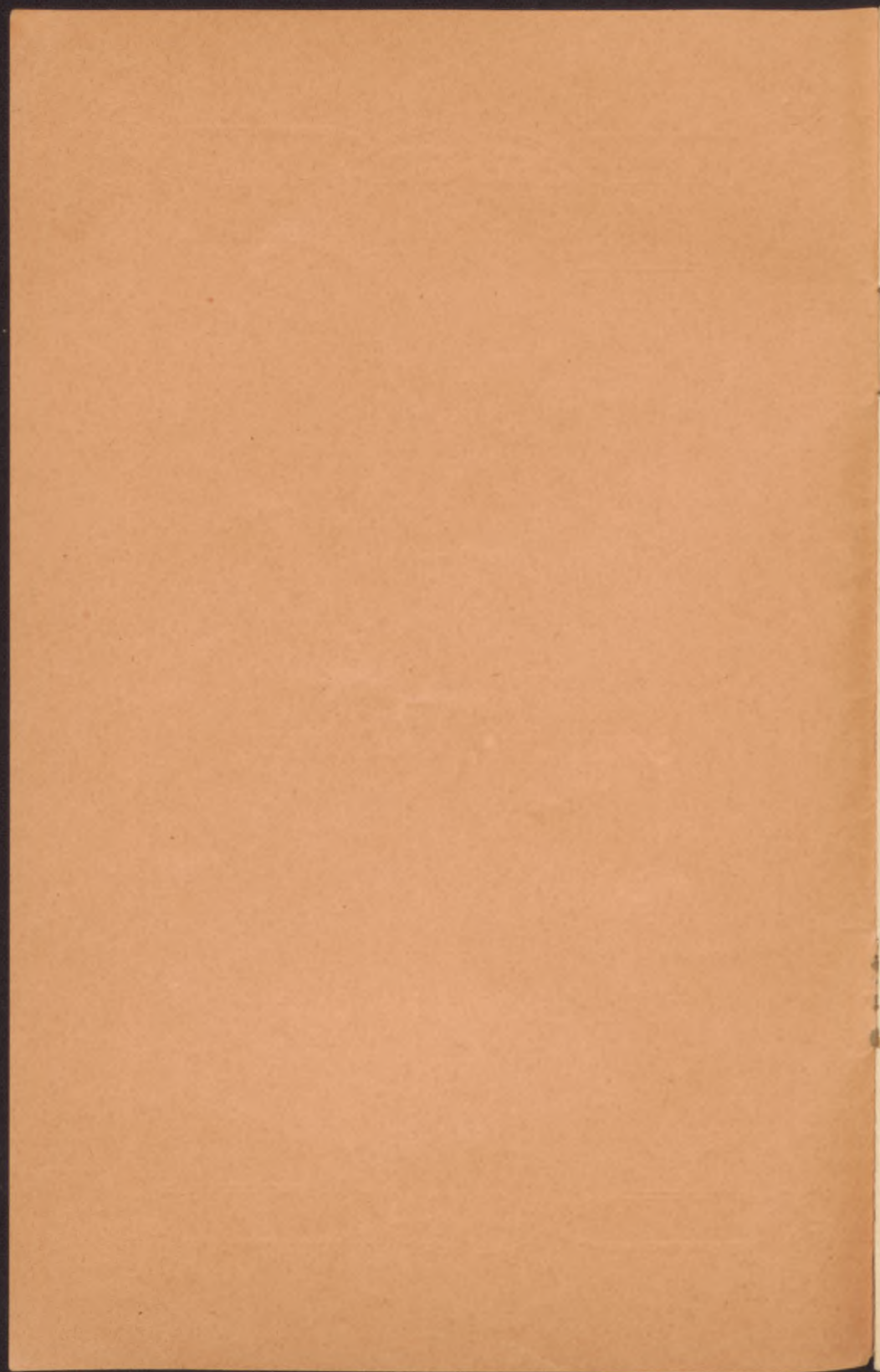


Town Hall, Melbourne



Monday Evening, 31st October,

1910



26TH CONCERT.

The Royal
Victorian Liedertafel

CONDUCTOR: MR. ERNEST WOOD.

✻

Town Hall, Melbourne,
Monday Evening, 31st October, 1910.

✻

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The Melbourne Orchestral Society

Ungarische Tänze *Johannes Brahms*
The Melbourne Orchestral Society

- 3 THREE DOUBLE CHORUSES FROM
 ŒDIPUS AT COLONOS (Nos. 3, 6, and 5)
Felix Mendelssohn-Bartholdy
 The Royal Victorian Liedertafel and Orchestra

- 5 "Eine Steppenskizze" A. Borodîn
- The Melbourne Orchestral Society

6 CANTATA.. .. "FRITHJOF" *Max Bruch*
SOPRANO SOLOIST: MISS LILIAN REID
BARITONE SOLOIST: MR. HORACE STEVENS

The Royal Victorian Liedertafel and Orchestra

GOD SAVE THE KING.

The Royal Victorian Liedertafel.

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Dr. MacGillicuddy	<i>'Celli Basses—</i>	<i>Trumpets—</i>
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" Rutland	" Tappe	" McKenzie
" Schoknecht	" Thatcher	
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Programme

PART I.

Ungarische Tänze *Johannes Brahms*

The Melbourne Orchestral Society

Solo—

“O Star of Eve”

Wagner

(*Tannhäuser*)

Mr. Horace Stevens

Double Choruses from Oedipus at Colonus.

MUSIC BY FELIX MENDELSSOHN-BARTHOLDY

(WITH ORCHESTRAL ACCOMPANIMENT)

The Royal Victorian Liedertafel and Orchestra

The Chorus sing the praises of Colonus.

Thou comest here to the land, O friend,
Fam'd for fleet-footed steeds and blooming meadows;
Thou standest now in Colonus' grove,
Where the voices of nightingales
Resound, floating in dulcet strains
Thro' their temples of verdura;
Where the thick-woven ivy clings,
Spreading over the sacred aisles;
Where, in security, ripens the fruitful vine,
Unscath'd by beam or stormwind.
And here roameth the bounteous god
Gay and good Dionysos, ever greeted in lays,
Sung by the nymphs who rear'd him.

Fair and fragrant at dawn of day
 See the beautiful heaven-bedewed Narcissus,
 The flow'r that shone in the goddesses' crowns,
 Worn by them in the days of old.
 See the Crocus array'd in gold;
 Hear the slumberless waters,
 While they glide in Cephisus' tide,
 Still meandering day by day
 Over the plains, bearing streams ever pure along,
 Enriching all the bowers
 Embosomed in the favour'd land;
 Ever loved by the tuneful choir of Muses,
 And Cythera, whose zone is golden.

Here, too, bloometh a tree
 Crowned with a fruit not found in Asia;
 Nor on Dorian plains doth it appear,
 Gracing the island where the Pelops
 Held sway; yet here it freely springeth;
 Rever'd by friends, and fear'd by foes,
 In native splendour it blossoms for Athens.
 Behold ours is the rich oil-dropping olive!
 Aged and youthful, noble and peasant,
 Never wantonly harm this holy tree.
 Guarded and cherished, it stands secure,
 Ever heeded by Morian Jove.
 Lov'd and watch'd by Minerva,

Grateful, let me extol
 Heaven's richest gifts designed to my country;
 Presented by the Pow'r making our State
 Fam'd for its wealth, honour, and glory:
 Our land and sea steeds, rein and rudder guided;
 O Chronos' son, by them we stand pre-eminent.
 Mighty god Poseidon,
 Thou didst give us the rein form'd for the courser;
 Guided thus, or curbed, he yields obedience.
 Through the billows we dash, stemming the deep,
 Speeded along by the oar and helm,
 Bounding on with the dancing nymphs—
 Nereus' hundred-footed daughters.

The Athenians are successful, and Theseus returns with Antigone and Ismene. Oedipus expresses his gratitude to the King, who announces the arrival of Polynices seeking an interview with his father. The chorus describes the sorrows of life, and the blessing of death when old age has come.

WHEN the health and the strength are gone
 He that still would be lingering here,
 Borne down by a load of care,
 Is, I consider, devoid of wisdom
 Old age bringeth disease and pain,
 Grief, anguish and regret remain.

For youth's bloom and its fleeting joys
Never, never return again.
Life's varied journeys lead to death;
Smooth or rugged, all its pathways,
Even its wishes, end in Hades.
Love hymeneal, revels, dances, strains of music
Cease, when the Foe appeareth!

Better not to exist;
Or, if born, in early childhood to die,
And escape all the cares and pains.
They, living longest, endure the longest.
Youth and Folly and Sorrow roam
Hand in hand to their destined home:
For none liveth devoid of care;
None escapeth what all must bear.
Envy, Sedition, Murder, Strife,
Fear and Rage hover around us:
And, in conclusion, feeble, helpless,
Old and friendless, all these ills together meeting
Crush their devoted victim.

On man, poor mourner, all these evils fall,
Fall as billows rushing beat the north strand,
Dashing onward, urged by the blast of winter.
Thus, then, storms of affliction, never-ending, assail us.
Thus lowering sorrows around us gather;
Whether from Helios' western bound,
Or from his eastern gate,
Or where his rays beam brightest,
Or down from the home of Arcturus.

Theseus, followed by the citizens of Athens, again appears, and learning what Creon has done, sends for soldiers and renews his promises of protection to Ædipus, declaring that his daughters shall be restored to him, and that Creon shall not be allowed to bring such a disgrace upon Athens. The chorus describes the contest, and invokes the aid of the Gods in favour of Theseus and his followers.

Ah, were I on yonder plain,
Where now our undaunted sons
Stand arm'd for the hostile fray;
There, where the shrine of Phœbus gleams,
And torches are burning;
Where Mortals bow down to the awe-inspiring pair,
Whose hallowed rites are mystic deeds,
Wrought by Eumolpidan priests,
And never breath'd to mortal ear.
There, glowing with ardour,
Panting to rush against the foe,
See, see all our legions,
With Theseus they wave their swords, and cry,
Rescue the sisters!

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Or westward perchance they rush,
 Where snow-cover'd mountains rise
 O'er Æa's enamelled meads!
 There dancing cars and prancing steeds
 Will clash in the onset!
 There on the foe soon will impending vengeance fall,
 For Theseus leads our valiant bands:
 See their arms and armour gleaming
 Bright as the trappings that grace their steeds!
 Now proudly exulting,
 They, who honour the deeds of sage Minerva,
 And Rhea's great son, earth encircling ocean's king,
 Press to the battle!
 Do they await, pursue or fight?
 My heart thrills with hope
 That they will soon rescue the captive maid,
 Who hath endur'd, and still endures her kindred's woe.
 This day, Jove will restore her.
 Crown your deeds, heroes, with glory!
 Like a dove high soaring,
 Sped along by the storm-wind,
 I, from the verge of a cloud,
 Would look down on the contest,
 And see my country's cause triumphant!
 Dread Pow'r that fillest heaven's high throne,
 O all-seeing Jove, defend our great ruler!
 On him the victor's palm bestow!
 With verdant laurels deck his brow!
 We call on thee, Pallas Athene!
 Mighty hunter, Phœbus, hear us!
 And thy sister, fleet in chase, whose dart unerring
 Pierceth the far-distant hart:
 O come, defend our guardians!
 We pray ye, aid our native heroes!

Solo—

"Ocean! Thou Mighty Monster" *Weber*

(*Oberon*)

Miss Lillian Reid

"Eine Steppenskizze" *A. Borodin*

The Melbourne Orchestral Society

Into the silence of the monotonous Steppes of Middle Asia come
 the first echoes of a peaceful Russian song. In the distance sound
 the trampling of horses and camels, and the strange cries of the
 Orient. Under the protection of the Russian flag it moves safely on
 its far journey through the immeasurable waste. It recedes further
 and further. The songs of Russia and the wild notes of the East
 merge into the solemn harmony of nature, slowly sinking into the
 echoes of the eternal Steppes.

—♦—
INTERVAL.

"FRITHJOF."

The story of Frithjof the Bold and Ingeborg the Fair is told in "Frithjof's Saga," a poem in twenty-four cantos, by Esaias Tegner, published in 1820.

The hero, Frithjof, is son to Thorsten Vikingsson, who, though King Bele's best warrior and chosen friend, is of lowly origin. Frithjof the Strong and Bold dares to love Fair Ingeborg, daughter of his king and descendant of great Odin. Bele looks kindly on young Frithjof's love, but death takes from the youth at once a monarch and a friend. When Frithjof subsequently demands the hand of Ingeborg from Helge, son and successor of Bele, he is rejected with scorn. Later, old King Ring, a mighty monarch of the North, would make fair Ingeborg his queen, but Helge, influenced by soothsayers, sends a refusal, accompanied by a taunting message from brother Halfdan, to "Old Grey-beard." King Ring incensed, declares war against the brothers, and Ingeborg is sent for safety to the vale of Baldur, the god of innocence and virtue. While in the sacred grove, the maiden receives a visit from her lover, the joy of which is followed by the fear that she has angered the gods by keeping a love-tryst in that holy place. At a council of war assembled at Bele's cairn, Frithjof again demands from Helge the hand of Ingeborg, in return for which he offers his best aid in the impending battle. Helge again repels him, and forces him to make the fatal admission that he has visited Ingeborg in the sacred grove. He thereupon denounces him as a profaner of temples, and orders him to do penance for his sacrilege by sailing to the Orkneys to wring from fierce Earl Agantyr long-withheld tribute. Frithjof tries to persuade Ingeborg to fly with him, but in vain. Giving her his arm-ring, he departs, promising to return and make her his bride.

Borne through his perilous voyage by his charmed ship "Ellida," Frithjof returns at length to his native land to find his estates laid waste with fire and sword, and the fair Ingeborg given in marriage to victorious King Ring. He learns that at the marriage ceremony the cowardly Helge tore from his sister's arm her lover's ring, and hung it upon the arm of Baldur's image. Frithjof, furious, seeks out the King whilst he is in the act of offering sacrifice at Baldur's pyre. He flings Agantyr's tribute full in Helge's face, and, hastily snatching at the arm ring, he overturns the huge idol upon the sacred fire. The flames lap it about, and, leaping upward with anery roar, spread to the temple and the sacred grove, which are soon reduced to ashes.

Frithjof is now shunned by all as a perpetrator of sacrilege; he is banished from his country, and, sailing away in the "Ellida," he devotes himself to a life of wild adventure. The hero's troubled life is ultimately crowned with happiness. After many years he returns to his native land, and succeeds in gaining the goodwill of King Ring, who at his death bequeaths him his kingdom and his queen.

Bruch, Max, musical composer, born at Cologne 6th January, 1838, received his first musical instruction from his mother (*nee* Almenröder), who was a highly-esteemed teacher of music, and who often in her young days sang at the Rhenish musical festivals. At the age of eleven Bruch, then a pupil of Karl Breidenstein, attempted compositions on a large scale, and at the age of fourteen he had already brought out a Symphony at Cologne. From 1853 to 1857 he held the Mozart Scholarship at Cologne, and in that capacity he was a special pupil of Ferdinand Hiller in the theory of music and composition; and of Karl Reinecke (till 1854), and of Ferdinand Breunung in playing the piano. After a short stay in Leipzig, he resided from 1858 to 1861 as musical teacher at Cologne, and was very assiduous in composing. On the death of his father, in 1861, he set out on an extensive tour of study, which, after brief stays at Berlin, Leipzig, Vienna, Dresden, and Munich, ended at Mannheim, where his opera "Lorelei" (after the text written by Geibel for Mendelssohn) was produced in 1863. At Mannheim also, between 1862 and 1864, he wrote the chorus-works, "Frithjof," "Römischer Triumphgesang," "Gesang der heiligen drei Könige," and "Flucht der heiligen Familie." In 1864-65 he was again on his travels, visiting Hamburg, Hanover, Dresden, Breslau, Munich, Brussels, and Paris. Then he brought out his "Frithjof" with extraordinary success at Aix-la-Chapelle, Leipzig, and Vienna. From 1865 to 1867 he was musical director at Coblenz, and from 1867 to 1870 director of the court choir at Sonderhausen. At Coblenz he wrote, among other things, his well-known first concerto for the violin, and at Sonderhausen two symphonies and portions of a Mass. The opera "Hermione," which was produced in 1872 at Berlin, where Bruch resided from 1871 to 1873, had only a *succès d'estime*. The chorus "Odysseus" likewise belongs to the period of the composer's residence at Berlin. After he had been five years (1873-78) at Bonn, devoting his time exclusively to composing "Arminius," "The Song of the Bell," and his second concerto for the violin, and after he had paid two visits to England for the purpose of producing some of his works, he became in 1878, on the resignation of Hockhausen, Director of Stern's Singing Academy at Berlin; and in 1880 he was nominated to succeed Sir Julius Benedict as Director of the Philharmonic Society at Liverpool.

PART II.

“FRITHJOF,”

CANTATA BY MAX BRUCH.

INGEBORG ... Miss LILIAN REID.

FRITHJOF ... MR. HORACE STEVENS.

QUARTET: MESSRS. G. J. JOHNSON, H. C. NICHOLLS, F. S. WHITEHEAD
AND J. FRANKLAND

The Royal Victorian Liedertafel and Orchestra

Instrumental Introduction.

Scene I.

FRITHJOF'S RETURN.

Recitative.

How bravely o'er the floods so bright,
Ellida flies to shore now in sight!
Although the king with demon spell
Invoked the horrid goblin brood,
And unloosed the wings of the tempest,
My Northland courage bore me
Through ardent strife
To glory's height;
From mighty Jarl the tribute I obtained!

I greet thee gladly, Baldur's grove,
Where oft by break of night
Hope filled my heart with sweet delight!
My Ingeborg, but where art thou now?
Beloved maiden, art thou true to me?
See I vie with the winds and their heavenly train.
Ellida, O hasten and fly o'er the main.

Chorus.

Oh, 'tis delight when the land afar appeareth,
And from the hearth of thy home beloved
The smoke curls upwards
And thou art near to childhood's scenes
For ever dear.

Solo—Frithjof.

On the tomb of my father I planted the lime-tree,
Is the delicate stem still alive?
Give, earth, thy growth,
And thou, O heaven, send fostering dew.
Oh 'tis delight!

Scene II.

INGEBORG'S BRIDAL PROCESSION TO KING RING.

MARCH—ORCHESTRA.

Chorus.

Sadly the Skald walks before the train,
Pale sits the bride on the coal black palfrey;
The angry Norna her arrow darteth,
She rules the mortals,
As their lot is cast.
From thunder-clouds ruin falls at last.

Solo Ingeborg—and Chorus.

My heart with sorrow overflowing,
Heeds not the flowers entwined with my ringlets;
Forever away from my home I go,
By my brother forced to wed his foe!
An endless woe in my bosom burneth,
But Bele's daughter pity spurneth!
Yet bear to Frithjof greetings from Ingeborg!
Great is my grief but I do not hate.
All-father judges
I bear my fate.

Scene III.

FRITHJOF'S REVENGE—TEMPLE IN FLAMES—
CURSE.

Chorus of Priests.

Midnight sun on the mountain burns,
Red like blood appearing,
And through the strange mysterious light
Helge's train is nearing.
Lo, he comes, while the glare is spread,
Splendid crown adorns his head,
Helge, mighty monarch!

By VICE-REGAL



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Recitative - Frithjof.

Go to Hela's dark abode,
Seek ye there the mighty rover;
Slain upon the horse he rode -
Helge's life is over!

Chorus.

Woe! Ch! wicked deed!

Frithjof.

Hush, wretched priests with gory knives,
Moonlight's pallid princes!
Hush! or tremble for your lives,
Long our blades have thirsted!
Where my father rests,
Where my childhood passed,
Nought save a ruin I found aghast!
And sold to the foe my beloved bride.
The armlet, which to her I left,
Behold, now the God wears it proudly,
And she is bereft!
Ah, Baldur! is this thy valiant deed?
By theft this armlet was given to thee!
Thou must, O Baldur, restore it to me!
How dar'st thou hold this ring in thy keeping,
Which once my Ingeborg blessed with weeping,
No longer on thine arm it shall rest!
My hope, my joy, thou could'st destroy,
But, mind! not me shalt thou decoy!

Chorus - Priests and People.

Woe! he tugs with all his might at the ring—O fright!
Ah! the God, now filled with wrath,
'Midst the flames is rushing,
And the consecrated hearth
By his weight is crushing.
Fane in flames!
Pour water on!
The waves of the sea bring hither!
Lo! clouds of smoke are bursting forth,
Morning winds blow from the North!
How the flames are glaring!
What availeth human might!
Now from branch to branch they spring
Through the combat daring!
Blazing flames in the grove abound
Onward like rivers flowing
Sunlight smileth,
But fjord and sound
Blood-red with fire are glowing,
Woe! Woe! Woe!

Priests.

Mischief bringer! malediction on thy head! accurs'd!

People and Priests.

Mount, smoke, and upwards to heaven ascending,
Valhalla enter, Valhalla enter.
Cry to the Gods, who o'er earth are bending.
And thou, O flame, the deed proclaim,
Fly, and proclaim to the Gods the accursed deed!

Frithjof's Followers.

Ashes our temple soon will be;
Frithjof from his home must flee!
Happy he who departs not forever!

Scene IV.

FRITHJOF GOES INTO EXILE.

Solo Quartette.

Sun in the sky
Now mounteth high,
The winds are blowing
And gently flowing,
The waves advance
In joyful dance.

Chorus.

Sadly Frithjof goes his way;
See, he weepeth, while morning gloweth!

Solo - Frithjof - and Chorus.

World's grandest region, thou mighty North,
From thy dominions I'm driven forth.
Within thy borders I lov'd to dwell!
Midsummer sun, fare thee well!
My love is foiled, my rooftree rent!
With honour soiled, in exile sent!
Cheerless is my soul within me,
Hopeless I must bear my lot.

Ye rugged mountains where heroes dwell,
And Thor commandeth clouds and winds;
Ye azure lakes that I love so well.
Ye woods and brakes, fare ye well!

Scene V.

INGEBORG'S LAMENT.

Solo—Ingeborg.

Storms wildly roar!
Billows break madly upon the shore.
Would 'neath the sod I were lying,
Winds o'er me sighing!
Sad and opprest,
Thee I did watch, flying sail in the west!
Onward with Frithjof thou glidest,
With him abidest.
Falcon, beloved! thee he left here;
Falcon, for his sake to me thou art dear.
Shake not thy pinions, stay near me,
O, why should'st thou fear me?

Here on his hand,
Worked on the canvas, thou proudly shall stand.
Silver thy pinions unfolden;
Thy claws shall be golden.
Thou darling bird!
Sit on my shoulder, and list to my word!
When I'm no more,
He will come hither, and his heart will be sore:
Greet from me, Frithjof,
Who loves me, and never forgets me.

Scene VI.

FRITHJOF ON THE SEA.

Chorus—Frithjof's Followers

Now he crossed the floods of the salt desert waste,
Far off like a falcon he flew!
But for warriors on board, he wrote maxims and rules!
List to the laws of his crew!

Frithjof and Chorus.

On this deck raise no tent,
And ashore do not sleep;
 Within houses the foe lurks for thee!
On thy shield sleep, Viking,
Thy sword in thy hand;
 Let the heavens thy canopy be.
Now hold high your lances —
 Your lances hold high —
Our banners unfold ye,
 The triumph is nigh.
To climes of the south we shall wander.
When hurricanes rage,
 Hoist the canvas on high!
Let them come as they may,
 He who flinches must die.
Rise, rise, unfold ye our banners!



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